



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2024-25
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II [SET A]

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

*Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.*

*The paper has four sections.
Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.
You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from
any section of your choice.
The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].
This paper consists of five printed pages.*

SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this section)

Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

- (i) “I wish your enterprise today may thrive” Identify the speaker of the quoted sentence.
(a) Popilius (b) Caesar
(c) Cassius (d) Artemidorus
- (ii) Select the option that shows the correct relationship between statements (1) and (2) from *Julius Caesar*:
1. Statement 1: Antony is allowed to speak after Brutus at Caesar’s funeral.
2. Statement 2: Romans turn against the conspirators.
(a) Statement 1 is the cause for statement 2.
(b) Statements 1 and 2 are independent of each other
(c) Statement 2 is the cause for statement 1.
(d) Statement 1 is an example of statement 2.
- (iii) How does Brutus justify Caesar’s assassination in his speech?
(a) He claims that Ceasar had done him wrong.
(b) He says that he wants to become the King.
(c) He claims that he was being threatened by Caesar.
(d) He believes that it was for the good of Rome.
- (iv) What happens after Brutus stabs Caesar?
(a) Caesar fights back.
(b) The conspirators all get together and stab Caesar again.
(c) Caesar says ‘Et tu Brute?’ and dies.
(d) The citizens rush in defence of Caesar.

- (v) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events in the correct order:
1. Antony reads the will of Caesar to the Romans.
 2. Antony says "Friends, Romans, countrymen" and starts his speech.
 3. Brutus speaks to the common Romans and wins their support.
 4. Antony asks the Romans to form a ring around the corpse of Caesar and shows them his wounds.
- (a) 3, 2, 4, 1 (b) 4, 1, 2, 3
(c) 1, 2, 3, 4 (d) 2, 3, 4, 1
- (vi) Which character trait of Brutus is highlighted when he allows Antony to speak at Caesar's funeral?
- (a) Lack of foresight and gullibility (b) Humility
(c) Arrogance (d) Insecurity
- (vii) Name the author of *The Elevator*.
- (a) Stephen Leacock (b) William Sleator
(c) Leigh Hunt (d) Satyajit Ray
- (viii) 'Some people have no legs at all.' Identify the speaker. (The Girl who Can)
- (a) Nana (b) Gustave Naudin
(c) Maya (d) Kaya
- (ix) Choose the option that has a similar figure of speech as in the line quoted below.
"They bit, they glared, gave blows like beams" (The Glove and the Lions)
- (a) *The waves beside them danced; but they
Out-did the sparkling waves in glee.*
(b) *A hundred years should go to praise
Thine eyes and on thy forehead gaze*
(c) *Mixed ready to begin the morning right,
Like the ingredients of a witches' broth*
(d) *Shall I compare thee?
Thou art more lovely and temperate.*
- (x) Which of the following is NOT true?
- (a) The photographer wanted to capture the real faces as they appeared.
(b) The narrator wanted to give his picture to his friends so that they can keep it as a memento after his death.
(c) The narrator was disappointed to see the photograph which was clicked.
(d) Delphide process was used by the photographer to put in new eyebrows.
- (xi) How is the King described? (The Glove and the Lions)
- (a) Hearty (b) Submissive and underconfident
(c) Ambitious and aggressive (d) Passively assertive
- (xii) What is the tone of the poem "When Great Trees fall"?
- (a) Hopelessness (b) Disdain and regretful
(c) Optimistic and hopeful (d) Pessimistic
- (xiii) How does the poet describe the lions? (The Glove and the Lions)
- (a) fierce and strong (b) tame
(c) friendly (d) lazy

(xiv) What do the following lines suggest:

*And when great souls die,
after a period peace blooms,
slowly and always
irregularly.*

(When Great Trees Fall)

- (a) Chaos and disorder will always prevail after the death of a loved one.
- (b) The absence will never allow us to heal.
- (c) Their legacy is quickly forgotten so we heal very quickly.
- (d) Healing and regeneration will happen over time.

(xv) One of the magazines that the narrator read while waiting for his turn to be photographed is _____. (With the Photographer)

- (a) The journal of Manhood 1912
- (b) Infants Journal for 1890
- (c) The famous Photographers of the World
- (d) Girls Magazine for 1902

(xvi) Which of the following words does H.W. Longfellow use to describe the movement of the phantoms in his poem, 'Haunted Houses'?

- (a) slide
- (b) glide
- (c) noiseless
- (d) invisible

SECTION B

DRAMA

(JULIUS CAESAR – Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

Brutus: *Then follow me and give me audience, friends.—
Cassius, go you into the other street,
And part the numbers.
Those that will hear me speak, let 'em stay here;
Those that will follow Cassius, go with him;
And public reasons shall be rendered...*

- (i) Where is this scene taking place? Why is there a need for 'public reasons' to 'be rendered'? Who is being referred to as 'friends'? [3]
- (ii) What do the 'friends' decide to do for Brutus soon after? What request does Brutus make to the 'friends' at the beginning of his speech? [3]
- (iii) Mention the two conditions which Brutus had wanted Antony to follow while giving his speech. Explain: Antony: "... The evil that men do lives after them;
The good is oft interrèd with their bones..." [3]
- (iv) How does Antony refer to Brutus in his speech? What examples of Caesar's generosity does Antony give in his speech? [3]
- (v) What impression do you form of Antony from his speeches in this scene? How does this scene contribute towards the overall development of the plot? What do you feel for Brutus towards the end of this scene and why do you feel so? [4]

Question 3

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

Antony: *This is a slight, unmeritable man,
Meet to be sent on errands. Is it fit,
The three-fold world divided, he should stand
One of the three to share it?*

- (i) Identify the listener. Name the 'slight, unmeritable man'. Where is this scene taking place? [3]
- (ii) What comparison does Antony use to describe the 'slight, unmeritable man' soon after the extract? How does Octavius praise the 'slight, unmeritable man'? [3]
- (iii) To what does the 'slight, unmeritable man' consent to at the beginning of the scene? What was the condition that he gave? What errand does Antony give him? [3]
- (iv) What does Antony plan to do with Caesar's will? What does Antony want to discuss with Octavius by sitting in 'council'? What 'great things' does Antony tell Octavius about? [3]
- (v) According to Antony, how should his own horse and the 'slight, unmeritable man' be treated in a similar way? Based on this scene, give any one character trait of Antony with suitable justification. [4]

SECTION C

PROSE- SHORT STORIES

(Treasure Chest- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

When we arrived in our village, she entered our compound to show the cup to my mother before going to give it back to the Headmaster.

- (i) Where does this story take place? What was this place famous for? Who is referred to as 'she' here? [3]
- (ii) Who is the speaker? How old was she? What was the biggest problem in her according to 'she'? [3]
- (iii) Why was it difficult for the speaker to see for herself the legs of any other woman who had children? How far was the village from the town? [3]
- (iv) Why did 'she' not want the speaker to go to school? What did 'she' do upon hearing that the speaker has been selected to run in the district games? Why did 'she' go to Mr. Mensah's house? [3]
- (v) How did 'she' react when the speaker won the 'best all-round junior athlete'? What is your opinion about 'she'? Justify with suitable textual references the significance of the title. [4]

Question 5

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Martin looked away, but the woman didn't turn around. Was she still looking at him?
He glanced at her quickly, then looked away again. She was still watching him.*

- (i) Who was Martin? Why was he always uncomfortable in elevators? Why did he not like the elevator of the building in which they had moved in recently? [3]
- (ii) Which incident at home made Martin decide to use the elevator always? What was happening to him in school? [3]
- (iii) Describe 'she'. What was Martin sure of when 'the woman' waddled into the elevator? [3]

- (iv) Explain in detail how did Martin fall. Why did his father leave him alone in the elevator after they returned from the hospital? [3]
- (v) 'His father was silent on the way to hospital, disappointed and angry with him for being a coward and a fool' What impression do you form of the father from this sentence? What advice would you give to the father if you happen to meet him? *The Elevator* is an open-ended story with no definite conclusion. How would you want this story to end? Elucidate. [4]

SECTION D

POETRY

(Treasure Chest- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*They existed. They existed.
We can be. Be and be
better. For they existed.*

- (i) Identify the poet. Explain the metaphor that has been used in the poem. [3]
- (ii) How do rocks, lions and elephants react when great trees fall? [3]
- (iii) How does the air become after the death of the great souls? Explain the meaning of the lines in the extract. [3]
- (iv) What happens after a period when great souls die? What are spaces filled with? What happens to our souls when great souls die? [3]
- (v) What happens to the small things in the forest when great trees fall? What is the central message of the poem? Do you think this poem will provide some support and hope to those who are afflicted with grief? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

Question 7

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*She thought, the Count my lover is brave as brave can be;
He surely would do wondrous things to show his love of me;
King, ladies, lovers, all look on; the occasion is divine...*

- (i) Who is referred to as 'my lover'? Name the king. What did the king tell the 'gentlemen'? [3]
- (ii) How does the poet describe the physical beauty of 'she'? What did she think about 'my lover' before throwing the challenge? [3]
- (iii) What was the immediate reaction of 'my lover' after she dropped her glove? What did he do with the glove? [3]
- (iv) The poet makes excellent use of imagery to describe the court setting and amplify the ferocity of the lions. Elaborate with textual examples. [3]
- (v) What do the actions of 'my lover' and 'she' reveal about their characters? What is one central theme of the poem? Justify with textual reference. [4]